

Lesson 04

Writing for Business Meetings



Warm-Up

Motivation Questions:

- What types of documents do you typically write for business meetings?
- Why is it important to write clear and concise documents for business meetings?
- Can you think of a meeting that was particularly effective or ineffective due to the quality of its written documents?
- How do you ensure your meeting documents are understood by all participants?





Sample Analysis

Study the following samples

Subject: Agenda for Team Meeting – April 7, 2025

Dear Team,

Please find below the agenda for our upcoming meeting:

1. Welcome and Introductions - John Green
2. Review of Previous Meeting Minutes - Alice Smith
3. Project Updates - Michael Johnson
4. Discussion on New Marketing Strategy - Emily Davis
5. Q&A Session - David Lee
6. Next Steps and Action Items - Sarah Brown

Best regards,

John Green

Subject: Minutes of Team Meeting – April 8 Dear Team,

Below are the minutes from our meeting held on April 7:

1. Welcome and Introductions - John Green
 - All members were present.
2. Review of Previous Meeting Minutes - Alice Smith
 - Minutes were approved without changes.
3. Project Updates - Michael Johnson
 - Project A is on track.
 - Project B requires additional resources.
4. Discussion on New Marketing Strategy - Emily Davis
 - Agreed to implement the new strategy starting next month.
5. Q&A Session - David Lee
 - Addressed questions regarding project timelines.
6. Next Steps and Action Items - Sarah Brown
 - Michael Johnson to follow up on resource allocation for Project B.
 - Emily Davis to prepare a detailed plan for the new marketing strategy.

Best regards,

CEO

Subject: Follow-Up on Team Meeting – April 9

Dear Team,

Thank you for attending the meeting on April 7. As discussed, please find attached the minutes of the meeting. Kindly review the action items and update your progress by the end of the week.

Best regards,

CEO

Analysis Questions:

- What elements make these documents clear and effective?
- How does the structure help the recipient understand the key points?
- What could be added to ensure all necessary information is included?

Discussion

- What are some common mistakes to avoid when writing business meeting documents?
- How can you make sure your agenda is concise yet informative?
- What are some strategies to ensure your minutes are accurate and comprehensive?
- What are the key elements that make a good meeting agenda?
- Why is it important to have clear and concise meeting minutes?
- How can follow-up emails enhance understanding after a meeting?



Vocabulary: Business Meeting Documents

Common components of Business Meeting Documents and key phrases

CONTENTS	COMPONENTS	KEY PHRASES
Meeting Agenda	- Title of the meeting - Date, time, and location - List of topics - Assigned speakers or facilitators	• <i>"The agenda for this meeting includes..."</i> • <i>"We will discuss the following topics..."</i>
Meeting Minutes	- Title with date - List of attendees - Summary of discussions - Action items and responsible parties	• <i>"The meeting commenced at [Time]."</i> • <i>"Key decisions made include..."</i> • <i>"Action items are as follows..."</i>
Follow-Up Email	- Reference to the meeting - Summary of discussion points - List of action items - Deadline reminders	• <i>"Thank you for attending the meeting on [Date]."</i> • <i>"Here are the key takeaways from our discussion..."</i>



Practice

QUIZ: Choose the correct answer

1. What is the purpose of a meeting agenda?

- a) To summarize the past meetings
- b) To outline topics for discussion in an upcoming meeting
- c) To review team performance
- d) To provide feedback

2. Who is responsible for taking minutes during a meeting?

- a) The project manager
- b) Any attendee who volunteers
- c) The facilitator of the meeting
- d) The team leader only

3. Which of the following should NOT be included in meeting minutes?

- a) The date and time of the meeting
- b) A detailed description of all discussions
- c) Personal opinions about attendees
- d) Action items and responsible parties

4. True or False: Action items in meeting minutes should include deadlines.

- a) True
- b) False

5. What is the correct salutation to use in a follow-up email after a meeting?

- a) "Hi everyone,"
- b) "Dear Team,"
- c) "To whom it may concern,"
- d) "Hey,"

6. A key phrase to use when summarizing decisions made in a meeting is:

- a) "In conclusion..."
- b) "I think that..."
- c) "It's important to note..."
- d) "Everyone should remember..."



Production

DOCUMENT WRITING EXERCISE

1. Work in pairs or small groups

2. Choose Your Document Type

- Meeting Agenda
- Meeting Minutes
- Follow-Up Email

3. Scenario Presentation

Choose one of the following scenarios:

- **Scenario 1:** A project update meeting for a software development team.
- **Scenario 2:** A budget review meeting with the finance department.
- **Scenario 3:** A strategy planning session for a new marketing campaign.

4. Writing Your Document

For Meeting Agenda:

- Title: "Agenda for [Document Type] – [Date]"
- Include date, time, and location.
- List at least 3 agenda items and their speakers.

For Meeting Minutes:

- Title: "Minutes of [Document Type] – [Date]"
- Include date, time, and attendees.
- Summarize discussions for at least 2 agenda items and 2 action items with responsible parties.

For Follow-Up Email:

- Subject Line: "Follow-Up on [Meeting Type] – [Date]"
- Thank the participants.
- Briefly summarize key points and action items with deadlines.
- Friendly closing.

5. Exchange and Review: Once the documents are written, present your document with to the class.

6. Feedback Session: Review each other's documents and provide constructive feedback on aspects such as clarity, structure, and effectiveness. Make sure your feedback is specific and actionable.



Key Vocabulary

Target Phrases	Use	Example
<i>Review of last meeting's action items</i>	To revisit and assess the tasks or decisions made in the previous meeting.	<i>Let's start with a review of last meeting's action items to ensure everything is on track.</i>
<i>Discussion on project deadlines</i>	To talk about and set timelines for project milestones and deliverables.	<i>Next, we will have a discussion on project deadlines to finalize our schedule.</i>
<i>The key takeaway is...</i>	To highlight the most important point or lesson from a discussion or presentation.	<i>The key takeaway is that we need to improve our customer service to increase satisfaction.</i>
<i>Action items assigned to...</i>	To specify the tasks and responsibilities given to team members.	<i>Action items assigned to John include drafting the proposal and coordinating with the marketing team.</i>

<i>To summarize, we agreed on...</i>	To recap the main decisions or agreements made during a meeting.	<i>To summarize, we agreed on the new project timeline and budget allocations.</i>
<i>The next steps include...</i>	To outline the actions that will follow a discussion or meeting.	<i>The next steps include finalizing the budget and scheduling a meeting with the stakeholders.</i>